A Typical Day for Mom

A family worksheet for morning, daytime, evening and overnight, as they are now.

“She's doing fine” is a label. “She makes her own breakfast, and my sister drives her on Thursdays” is a day, and a day is something the whole family can read and recognize.

Ask Mom to walk you through an ordinary day and write what she says, the way she says it. Add what you've seen yourself, with your name beside it. Write what happens now, and where nobody knows, write “not yet known” and leave it.

Morning

From when she gets up until around midday. What she does herself, what someone does with her or for her, and who that is.

FOR EXAMPLE “I'm up at six-thirty. I make my own breakfast and do the crossword before anything else.” (Mom)

Daytime

Errands, appointments, visitors, meals, time on her own. Name the days where the days differ.

FOR EXAMPLE Thursdays: Karen drives her to her appointment and they shop for groceries after. The neighbor brings in the mail most days. Not sure which days.

Evening

Supper, phone calls, how the day winds down.

FOR EXAMPLE David phones on Wednesday nights, around seven. Mom says she has supper with the news on.

Overnight

What the family knows about the hours after bedtime. If nobody has asked her, write that and leave it.

FOR EXAMPLE None of us has asked Mom what her nights are like. Not yet known.

What has changed, and when

Anything about her day that is different from how it used to be, with a rough date. Write what changed, not what you think it means and not what anyone thinks should change next.

FOR EXAMPLE Karen started doing the Thursday drive last winter, when the roads were icy, and has kept it up since.

Who filled this in, who they asked, and the date

What this shows you

One ordinary day, in Mom's words and yours: what she does herself, where someone already lends a hand, and the hours nobody in the family has asked about. It doesn't show how she is managing or whether anything should be different. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, and a day is one part of the family's picture, not the whole of it.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down an ordinary day, in Mom's words and yours, instead of a label. The care interview picks up from there: it asks about each part of her daily life in turn, including the parts no one thought to mention, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

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